

Your First 90 Days as New Toastmasters Member



Onboarding, clear structures, and active participation from the very beginning

“You never get a second chance to make a first impression! The first 90 days lay the foundation for long-term Toastmasters membership. A quick start, with a smooth, step-by-step introduction to the Toastmasters concept and the necessary tools, makes all the difference between enjoyment and frustration!”

Day 1-2	Week 1-2	Week 3-4	Month 2-3
Welcome Email Send a welcome email to the member as soon as the application is received	Introduction & Onboarding Add a member, onboarding in Pathways, easySpeak, Base Camp	Mentoring & Club-Meetings Find a mentor, actively participate in meetings (impromptu speech, technical role such as timekeeper)	Pathways Speeches & Meeting Roles Active Participation

What Really Matters

Arriving at the Club (including access to Easyspeak) ☐ Receive the application and file it centrally ☐ Add the member to Easyspeak so they can actively participate in the club meeting ☐ Send a welcome email with introductory materials (links to the Starter Guide, Member Roadmap, onboarding video, etc. -> within 3 days at most! ☐ Initiation Ritual 1: For example, add the person to a WhatsApp or email group and welcome them to the club. ☐ Initiation Ritual 2: Have a one-on-one conversation. Offer congratulations and build a connection (People want to be seen! Don't underestimate this!) ☐ Initiation Ritual 3: Encourage the new member to join you for a beer to chat informally and get to know each other	Onboarding in Pathways and Tools ☐ After receipt of payment: Register the member with TMI within the first 2-3 days and provide the Pathways checklist! ☐ Members should participate in the monthly Pathways training as soon as possible ☐ Members should select a learning path at the same time ☐ Icebreaker: Schedule a follow-up Speech and hand out project documents (even if the meeting isn't for another 2 months) ☐ Impromptu speech or technical role (have someone else take on the role of timekeeper, filler word counter, etc.) -> Encouragement and role description
Clarify the member's goals and expectations (VPE) ☐ Admissions Interview: Clarifying Goals, Motivation, and Expectations ☐ Clarify any open questions about the icebreaker	Mentoring (answers questions, provides structure, offers encouragement) ☐ Find a Mentor ☐ Support with meeting procedures and using easySpeak ☐ Assistance with preparing speeches and using Base Camp ☐ Create a rough 180-day mini-plan (speeches/roles)
Delivering Pathways Speeches ☐ Work through the project in PW -> Prepare an icebreaker speech ☐ Deliver an icebreaker speech and discuss it with your mentor afterward ☐ Celebrate the icebreaker at the club! -> e.g., PIN handoff and “Welcome to the TM Family” toast ☐ Evaluate Feedback Received (Independently) ☐ Documentation: Complete the Project in Base Camp ☐ Work through the Pathways checklist -> Prepare for the next project meeting	Take over meeting duties ☐ Become Proficient in Using easySpeak Encourage members to take on meeting roles: ☐ First, technical roles such as timekeeper, filler word counter, and speech style analyst ☐ then moderation and judging roles such as Toastmaster, Chief Judge, Judge, and Impromptu Speech Moderator ☐ Encourage a member to give an impromptu speech ☐ Enter meeting roles in the Pathways checklist and assign them to the handbook/level in Easyspeak

“The first 90 days make the difference between a visitor and a passionate member.”

The dropout rate among new members who didn't get off to a good start is high! In addition to stage fright, they're bombarded with a lot of information right from the start. That's why it's important to break things down into small steps, structure them clearly, and make successes visible. Otherwise, members quickly become overwhelmed and lose interest even faster.